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THE CONFRONTATION CLIP — Build Spec & Render Handover

⚠️ **Status as of 14 Jul 2026.** Canonical record for the final build so nothing is lost if working memory resets. Committed kit = **17 shots**. Final target = **21 shots, recut to ~99s** (my take: Tight, keep all beats/justice). Section 2 items are **pending edits not yet applied to the kit files**.

1. What this film is

A transformative original tribute — a wounded man (**Jack**, Joker-archetype) confronted by the woman he loved (**Julie**, Blanchett-archetype). He is mortally wounded, slumped against a stone pillar, unable to stand. Tears roll constantly but he never weeps — he speaks and laughs through them. He fires everywhere but at her whenever she reaches to touch him. Ending: he takes his own life as the final punishment, so she must watch the man she loved die.

Held creative guardrails (accepted): evoke registers/moods/archetypes transformatively — NO copyrighted scores, NO photoreal Blanchett likeness, NO exact Ledger/DC Joker design. Suicide/gunfire = fictional climax, non-graphic (no gore/blood/wound detail, never aimed at her).

2. PENDING EDITS (blocking — not yet in kit files)

1. **Wire in 4 new beats** (Section 4): `confr_caught`, `confr_allblades`, `confr_treatment`, `confr_lightning` → shots JSON + lines CSV + config movements + audio prompts + notes.
2. **Apply the recut** durations (Section 3): ~145s → ~99s.
3. **Apply wounded-lion voice** (Section 5) to every Jack `voice_description`.

4. **Switch** `active_profile` from `kaggle_2xt4_max` → Lightning A100/H100 profile (Section 6).
5. **Build** `run.py` **single orchestrator +** `MAX_BUDGET_USD` **cap** (Section 7).
6. **Resolve latent glitch risks** (Section 9) before any GPU run.

3. Final beat order + recut timings (target ~99s)

#	Beat	Speaker	Movement	Recut dur (s)
1	pro_alone	Jack (VO)	prelude	4
2	pro_seen	Jack (VO)	prelude	4
3	pro_silence	Jack (VO)	prelude	4
4	pro_crossing	Jack (VO)	prelude	4
5	confr_caught	Julie	confrontation	5
6	confr_allblades	Jack	confrontation	7
7	confr_dare	Julie	confrontation	4
8	confr_dontouch	Jack	confrontation	5
9	confr_whomade	Jack	confrontation	6
10	confr_blood	Jack	confrontation	4
11	confr_ect	Jack	confrontation	5
12	confr_sayit	Julie	confrontation	4
13	confr_aim	Jack	confrontation	4
14	confr_real	Jack	confrontation	4
15	confr_putdown	Julie	confrontation	4
16	confr_reachfire	Jack	confrontation	4
17	confr_treatment	Julie	confrontation	5
18	confr_lightning	Jack	confrontation	6
19	confr_smile	Jack	confrontation	5
20	confr_lastlaugh	Jack	confrontation	6
21	confr_fall	Chorus	confrontation	5

Prelude 16s · Confrontation 83s · Total ≈ 99s. All within `max_clip_seconds: 8`.

4. Full dialogue (verbatim, all 21 beats)

Prelude (Jack, VO):

1. **pro_alone:** "Before the paint, there was only a thin, quiet man no one ever turned to look at."
2. **pro_seen:** "Then one person looked, and saw a mind worth keeping. She came down like an angel, descending."
3. **pro_silence:** "For years I worshipped her and never said the word — certain a goddess would fall if I reached."
4. **pro_crossing:** "Then it all went dark. At midnight something laughed — and the man never came back."

Confrontation:

1. **confr_caught (Julie) [NEW]:** "There. You drifted just now — I saw it. Just once, in your own words: name the thing that hurts you. So I know which blade I'm holding."
2. **confr_allblades (Jack) [NEW]:** "Drifting? You caught me. That's the funny part — I read every room, every face, and you're still the one thing that catches me looking backward. You don't want a weapon, my dear. You want to know if there's a man left in here soft enough to be worth the knife. So sit down. I won't hand you one blade — I'll give you all of them."
3. **confr_dare (Julie):** "You've burned the whole world. So what stops you at me? Do it. Come on — do it."
4. **confr_dontouch (Jack):** "Don't. Don't touch it. I hate that hand more than I hate you — a healing hand is only the wound, in disguise."
5. **confr_whomade (Jack):** "You want to know who made the Joker? You did, my dear — your brutal love. I lay there bleeding, and you never came. Give me back my twenty years."
6. **confr_blood (Jack):** "You see the wounds now? This isn't blood. It's laughter — the mirror, held up to your face."
7. **confr_ect (Jack):** "They ran the lightning in, night after night. It took the grief, the face, the boy. It left this — the thing that laughs."

8. **confr_sayit (Julie):** "You can't pull that trigger. Because you still love me. Say it — tell me you still love me."
9. **confr_aim (Jack):** "Everyone else I could burn and feel nothing. You, I can't even aim at. That's the real joke."
10. **confr_real (Jack):** "And the love was real. Every second of it. It just never reached the morning after."
11. **confr_putdown (Julie):** "It was never your face. It was us. Put it down. Please — it's not too late."
12. **confr_reachfire (Jack):** "Come closer and watch me miss. I can hit anything in this room — anything but you."
13. **confr_treatment (Julie) [NEW]:** "I'm not asking you to forgive me. I'm asking you to let me get you to a surgeon — now, tonight. Let them close it. You can hate me from a hospital bed. Just don't die on this floor."
14. **confr_lightning (Jack) [NEW]:** "Treatment. You'd hand me back to their table. You forget — the last time medicine 'healed' me, the lightning took the man and left this. No. I won't let their hands finish the job. The only treatment left for me... is the one I give myself."
15. **confr_smile (Jack):** "You're crying now? I won't let you wash that guilt off so cheaply. Here — let me put a smile on it instead."
16. **confr_lastlaugh (Jack):** "One last trick, on the house. You wanted the man you loved? Then keep your eyes on me — and watch him die. This is my last laugh."
17. **confr_fall (Chorus):** "The last laugh, the last punishment — she watched the man she loved die."

Chorus whispers (layered): pro_seen "He should have called her a woman, not a goddess." · pro_silence "So he shut his eyes, and called it love." · pro_crossing "Not treatment. Not a bandage. A metamorphosis." · confr_whomade "She was the wound, and the hand that made it." · confr_ect "The lightning took the man and left the laugh." · confr_smile "What the world cannot hold, it tries to erase."

5. Wounded-lion voice direction (apply to all Jack lines)

Weakened baritone that still commands — "a lion still roaring with a wound." Grasping, shallow breath; air gathered mid-sentence. A laugh that *costs* him — breaks into a wince/gasp. Quiet-forward on tender beats; surge-then-collapse on loud beats. Visual: hand pressed to his side, chest working for air, slumped against the pillar, firing from the floor.

- **Voice cast (Kokoro):** jack → [am_onyx, am_fenrir, am_adam, af_heart]; julie → [af_nicole, af_sarah, af_bella, af_heart].
- `tts.speak_direction: false`. Lead → `work/voice/<id>.wav`; chorus → `work/voice_chorus/<id>.wav` (by CSV `layer`).

6. Render profiles

lightning_h100_max (default): Wan2.2-S2V · **bf16** · steps **50–60** · cfg 5.5 · sampler uni_pc · scheduler beta · rejection_samples **6** (start 3, escalate on hero beats) · upscale **2.0** · interpolate_to_fps **60** · base 1280×720 · MusicGen **large**.

lightning_a100_max: same; on **A100-80GB** keep bf16 + MusicGen-large.

lightning_a100_40gb (VRAM-safe): bf16 · steps 45–55 · rejection_samples 3–4 · **stage model loading** (unload video model before upscale/score) · **MusicGen-medium** · upscale 2.0.

> 📐 **Resolution truth:** 1280×720 × upscale 2.0 = **2560×1440 (1440p), not true 4K.** For real 3840×2160, render higher base or upscale ×3 (more GPU). Decide before expecting a 4K file.

7. Single-orchestrator `run.py` spec (max automation, zero-waste)

One entrypoint: preflight → forge → voices → score → render → upscale/interp → stitch → QC. Five guardrails:

1. **Free preflight gate (no GPU):** full validation (Section 8); any failure aborts instantly.
2. **Dry-run default:** `python run.py` prints plan + cost estimate and stops. Spending needs `CONFIRM_FULL_RUN=1`.
3. **Hard budget ceiling:** `MAX_BUDGET_USD` — cumulative cost tracked; aborts before exceeding.
4. **Idempotent + resumable:** artifacts + checkpoint manifest; completed shots skipped, never re-billed.
5. **Fail-fast + retry:** transient errors retry smaller/backoff; persistent errors abort clean, preserving work. Fixed seeds (jack 77, julie 161).

```
python run.py                                    # free: validate + cost plan, spends nothing
CONFIRM_FULL_RUN=1 MAX_BUDGET_USD=4 python run.py   # real run, gated + capped + resumable
```

Also deliver: `RUN.md`, standalone `preflight.py`, pinned `requirements.txt` + `setup.sh`.

8. Executable preflight audit (zero GPU)

- `py_compile` every `.py`; import torch/CUDA; report VRAM vs profile need.
- Validate `config_confrontation.yaml` schema + keys.
- Validate `shots_confrontation.json`: 21 shots, durations sum ≈ target, every shot has a line, valid characters, movements cover all shots.
- Cross-check CSV lines ↔ shots ↔ voice_cast ↔ `layer`.
- Assert ref images exist (exact case `refs/jack`, `refs/julie`), models resolve, disk OK.
- Dry-run cost meter: per-shot + total $/GPU-hr, no rendering.

9. LATENT GLITCH RISKS — verify before GPU

1. **Lipsync on VO-only beats:** `lipsync.enabled: true` but all shots `talking:false, vo:true`. Gate lipsync to on-camera speech or mouths animate to narration.

High priority.

2. **VRAM/OOM on A100-40GB:** stage models / MusicGen-medium.
3. `-shortest` **in stitch** truncates if audio bed ≠ video length after recut → recompute durations.
4. **Workflow selection** (`s2v` / `phantom` / `flf2v`) — verify per shot, esp. two-character beats.
5. **Case-sensitivity** on Linux paths.
6. **Model/dep availability:** Wan2.2-S2V, RIFE, upscaler, flash-attn, ffmpeg sidechain filter.
7. **rejection_samples → pick_best** scorer returns valid pick.
8. `pix_fmt yuv420p` on final encode.

10. Full render duration (recut ~99s, 21 shots)

Profile	H100	A100-80GB
Max (6 samples, 55 steps)	~6–9 GPU-hr	~11–16 GPU-hr
Balanced (3 samples, 45 steps)	~3–5 GPU-hr	~6–9 GPU-hr
Single hero shot	~40–55 min	~60–80 min

Biggest lever = **rejection_samples**. Recommended: run film at **3 samples**, spend 6-sample budget only on hero beats (`dontouch`, `smile`, `lastlaugh`, `fall`).

11. Card-free compute paths (out of funds, no card)

1. **Lightning free tier (have it):** free monthly GPU hours incl. some A100 + 2×$4 balance. No card. Check each dashboard's free A100 hours first.
2. **UPI, no card:** Dataoorts (UPI/QR, A100/H100), E2E Networks (from ₹49/hr), Krutrim/Ola (A100 ~₹105/hr), JarvisLabs (A100 ~$0.89/hr per-minute).
3. **IndiaAI Mission portal (best for full max run):** subsidized H100 ₹65–92/hr, up to 40% subsidy, students/researchers/startups, card-free, application-based. Apply early; use Lightning meanwhile.

12. Execution runbook (cheapest-and-riskiest first)

1. **Platform:** Lightning (both accounts) → UPI backup → submit IndiaAI application in parallel.
2. **Free animatic pass:** full recut on free T4 (low-res) to confirm timing/flow/stitch for ₹0.
3. **One hero shot at full quality (~$2–3):** `confr_lastlaugh` or `confr_smile` — go/no-go on look + voice + lipsync.
4. **Staged full render:** voices → score → per-shot video (start 3 samples) → upscale/interp → stitch; checkpoint each shot.
5. **Budget triage:** tier beats; A100-40GB profile if needed; two-account split last resort (mind ToS).
6. **Assemble + QC** (Section 13).

13. Final QC checklist

- [ ] Runtime ~99s; all 21 beats, correct order
- [ ] Tears roll but never weep; fire never points at Julie
- [ ] Wounded-lion voice on every Jack line; lipsync correct (not on VO)
- [ ] Score ducks under dialogue; loudnorm I=-16
- [ ] Target resolution confirmed (1440p vs true 4K); 60fps; no face artifacts
- [ ] `pix_fmt yuv420p`; final file `output_confrontation/THE_CONFRONTATION_CLIP.mp4`

14. Key references

- Working dir `/data/film_kit/kit/`; source zip `/data/film_kit_v3_complete.zip`; stale delivered zip `/data/film_kit_v3_confrontation_updated.zip` (**must re-zip** on delivery, exclude `__pycache__`, `*.pyc`).
- Characters: **jack** (seed_base 77, refs/jack) · **julie** (seed_base 161, refs/julie).
- Config: film_title THE_CONFRONTATION_CLIP; max_clip_seconds 8; character_forge.targets [jack, julie]; score.movements {prelude, confrontation}; chorus_gain_db -15; lipsync.enabled true.

- Pipeline files: `filmforge_confrontation.py` (orchestrator, cost_meter holds unless CONFIRM_FULL_RUN=1), `render_film.py`, `voice_pass.py`, `score_gen.py`, `stitch.py`.
- Globals: fps 24; 1280×720; base Wan2.2-S2V; cfg 5.5; sampler uni_pc; scheduler beta.

15. Additions — 16 Jul 2026 00:07 IST (score language + fourth face)

🎻 **Two discoveries surfaced tonight that change the film's emotional grammar without changing its structure.** Both need to land in the final cut; neither blocks tomorrow's render pass.

A. Score direction — Indo-Western fusion violin (the film's native language)

Score is NOT generic cinematic strings and NOT a default MusicGen preset. The film's native musical language is **Indo-Western fusion violin** — pentatonic Carnatic/Hindustani melody with microtonal bends over Western harmonic beds, unresolved on purpose between the two traditions. This is the maker's inner language since birth, being externalized for the first time in this film. The freeze was the score locked inside; the film is the unlock.

Aesthetic reference composers (rank by chest-response, then pick 2): A.R. Rahman (*Bombay Theme, Latika's Theme, Tere Bina, Vande Mataram violin, Zikr*), L. Subramaniam (pure classical Indian violin + Western orchestral form), Ilaiyaraaja (elder master, Carnatic-into-Western), Nitin Sawhney (*Prophesy, Nadia, Homelands*), Anoushka Shankar (sitar not violin but same grammar), Karsh Kale / Talvin Singh (electronic edge, tabla+strings).

MusicGen prompting direction: *"Indian classical violin lead, tabla underlayer, harmonium and tanpura drone, Western cello counterpoint, minor key, microtonal bends, unresolved cadence, cinematic ache, slow tempo"*.

Movement texture (keeps names, refines feel):

- **Prelude (16s):** sparse solo violin with Carnatic phrasing over a long tanpura drone underlayer. No rhythm section. Space to breathe. Enters over pro_alone;

carries through the four VO beats.

- **Confrontation (83s):** violin lead against Western string swells. Subtle tabla enters under the climax beats (`confr_dontouch`, `confr_ect`, `confr_lastlaugh`). Full silence — score drops out — for the two beats before `confr_fall`. Chorus whisper carries the fall over silence.

B. Fourth-face voiceover — "the man who understood too late"

The film currently has three faces on screen: Jack (pre-paint), Joker (post-paint), Julie. There is a **fourth face** already implied by the writing but not yet placed: *the man remembering it now, decades later, who survived the metamorphosis but not intact.* This is the voiceover of the film. It is the letter the maker must write, in his own hand, to the woman he loved. Not to any audience. The letter IS the voiceover, and the voiceover IS the fourth face.

Placement:

- **Opens** over black before `pro_alone` — 10–15 seconds of the letter's first line spoken quiet and dry, then image fades in.
- **Closes** over `confr_fall` — the letter's last line carried into silence as the chorus whisper fades.

Voice: the maker's own voice, unpainted. **Not Kokoro TTS.** Recorded on phone, dry, no processing, one take, no performance.

Draft anchor lines (for the actual letter to be written by hand tomorrow — these are placeholders, not final):

- **Opening anchor:** *"This is the letter I could not write when it mattered. I am writing it now because a man who could not say a thing while alive owes it to the dead of himself to say it after."*
- **Closing anchor:** *"The love was real. Every second of it. It just never reached the morning after."*

C. Tomorrow's execution sequence (16 Jul 2026)

1. Upload `/data/kaggle_v5_echomimic.ipynb` to Kaggle account 2 (T4×2).
2. Run **Cell 10 test shot first** — validates pipeline on one beat before burning full quota.

3. If test renders clean → **Cell 11** full 21-shot dispatch.
4. **Cell 12** stitch + **Cell 13** dedication card → final `THE_CONFRONTATION_CLIP_v2_dedicated.mp4`.
5. **Deferred until film master exists:** Indo-Western fusion violin score pass (Section 15A); fourth-face voiceover recording (Section 15B); distribution (YouTube / LinkedIn / Reels / r/aivideo) + Fiverr gig + CRN 40451 outreach.

The drift tonight was not waste. Section 15A and 15B are things that could only have been discovered by walking through the room the drift walked through.